3 Click the Create a New Secret Key button. A modal will pop up prompting you for details (figure A.2).

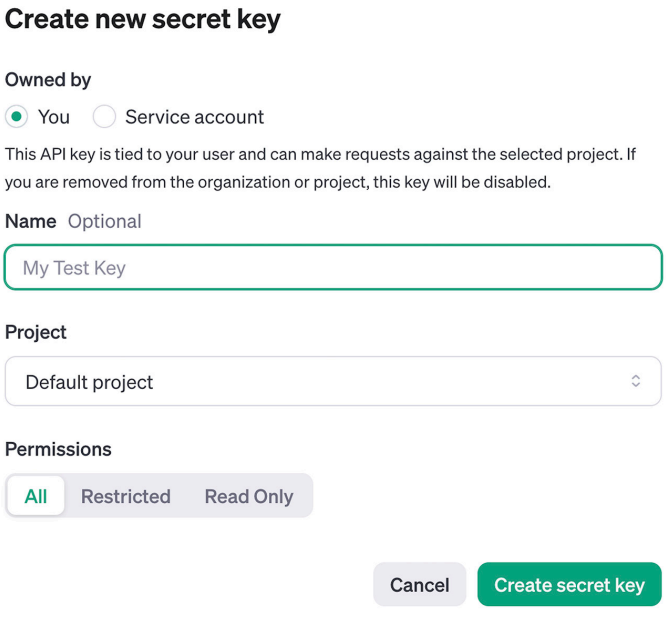


Figure A.2 Creating a new secret key in the OpenAI page

4 Fill in the form details in the model that appears. You have an option to configure individual API endpoint permissions.
5 Copy the generated secret key string and paste it into your clipboard. You won't be able to see it again otherwise, and you will have to create a new key to view it again.
6 Once you have your OpenAI API key, you need to add it to your project. In the root directory of the project you want to run, create a file named .env and add the secret key there:

```
OPENAI_API_KEY=your_secret_key_here
```

Now you should be able to access the AI model functionality.

NOTE As of the end of 2025, OpenAI no longer provides free API credits or a free usage tier to new accounts by default. When creating a new account, you will be required to set up billing and prepurchase credits before you can use the API. The system will prompt you to start billing immediately, and API calls will not work without an active payment method and purchased credits. This applies regardless of using new phone numbers or email addresses.